Christian Volunteer Services (CVS) Cloud Migration Analysis

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Video link:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/13YwnAmRsGrRDKk59D3ygWzIKTzj5Kzfm/view?usp=drivesdk

SWOT Analysis - Current IT Infrastructure

Strengths

- **40 dedicated IT staff at head office**
- **6.4GB critical donor & member database**
- **260 operational shops - national reach**
- **Board committed £10M investment**
- **Established fundraising CRM infrastructure**

Weaknesses

- Legacy CRM costs £7M/yr - 15 days downtime
- 5 incompatible payroll systems across 16 offices
- No e-commerce capability
- £6.4M/yr on hardware (CapEx model)
- 18 Staff just to maintain failing Legacy system

Opportunities

- SaaS CRM/HRM/Payroll cuts £7M+ licensing
- Cloud analytics unlocks 6.4GB donor data
- E-commerce portal - new income from 260 shops
- CapEx to OpEx frees funds for care services
- Microsoft nonprofit pricing reduces cloud costs

Threats

- Staff resistance via unions (IT + marketing)
- UK GDPR risk for donor personal data in cloud
- Legacy data migration failure risk
- Budget overrun risk on £10M limit
- Breadband dependency across 260 shop locations

SWOT Analysis - Proposed Cloud Infrastructure

Cloud migration converts CVS's biggest weakness into a strategic strength. Microsoft Azure recommended: nonprofit pricing, UK data residency, native Microsoft 365 integration (Microsoft, 2024).

Strengths

- Unified SaaS CRM across all 260 shops
- Single cloud payroll replaces 5 systems
- Real-time donor analytics on Azure
- Cloud DR - zero downtime risk
- Cloud Disaster recovery zero downtime risk

Weaknesses

- Internet dependency at 260 shop locations
- 3-year migration - operational disruption
- Staff retraining investment required
- Risk of vendor lock-in with Microsoft
- Ongoing Subscription Costs Require Budgeting.

Opportunities

- Microsoft Nonprofit - £3,500/yr free credits
- AI-driven legacy donation forecasting
- National e-commerce generates new income
- BPaaS automates volunteer management
- Standardised systems reduce it headcount long-team

Threats

- Provider outage affects all 260 locations
- Expanded cybersecurity attack surface
- Staff redundancies risk reputation damage
- Evolving UK cloud data regulation(UK GDPR)
- E-commerce Logistics complex across 260 Shops

SaaS, PaaS & IaaS service provision analysis

SaaS

Salesforce NPSP (CRM) - 10 free licences for charities via Power of Us (Salesforce, 2024

Microsoft 365 + Dynamics 365 HR - unified comms, HR & admin for 4,000 staff

Sage Business Cloud Payroll - replaces 5 regional payroll systems across 16 offices

PaaS

Azure App Service + Docker + Kubernetes - containerised e-commerce portal for 260 sh

Containers scale automatically for weekend donation upload spikes (Microsoft, 2024)

Azure Synapse Analytics - unlocks insights from 6.4GB donor database for fundraising

IaaS

Azure Virtual Machines (UK South) - lift-and-shift of 6.4GB legacy donor data

Virtualisation: one physical server hosts multiple VMs - eliminates £6.4M hardware spen

Azure Site Recovery - eliminates the 15 days downtime CVS lost in 2016/17 (CVS Brief, 2

Recommended Provider: Microsoft Azure

1. Integration

- Staff already use Windows, Office, Outlook daily
- Azure + Microsoft 365 + Dynamics 365 connect natively
- Reduces training cost & migration risk
- Cited as Leader - Gartner (2023)

2. Nonprofit Pricing

- Registered UK charities qualify
- £2,660 in free Azure credits/year
- Up to 75% off Microsoft 365 licences
- AWS has no equivalent UK charity programme

3. UK Data Residency

- Azure UK South - London data centre
- All 6.4GB donor data stays in the UK
- Satisfies UK GDPR with zero extra config
- ICO compliant (ICO, 2021)

AWS reviewed and set aside - no UK charity programme, weaker Microsoft 365 integration

Cost Analysis

Current IT cost: £14.9M/year Cloud estimate: £1.2M/year running cost

Service	Provider	Model	Annual Cost
Azure VMs + Blob Storage	Microsoft Azure	Consumption	£400,000
Microsoft 365 (4,000 staff)	Microsoft	Subscription	£211,200
Salesforce NPSP (120	Salesforce	Subscription	£86,400
Sage Payroll (unified)	Sage	Subscription	£48,000
Azure App Service + AKS	Microsoft Azure	Consumption	£220,000
Azure Synapse Analytics	Microsoft Azure	Consumption	£90,000
Azure Integration Services	Microsoft Azure	Consumption	£120,000
Year 1 Migration & Training	Third party	Fixed	£1,500,000

Khajeh-Hosseini et al. (2010): IaaS migration reduces costs 37% over 5 years | McKinsey (2025): cloud saves 20-40% | Saving funds CVS's care services

INaaS & BPaaS service & development analysis

INaaS	INaaS Integration as a Service connecting Salesforce, Sage, Microsoft 365, Azure App Service and all 260 shop systems via Logic Apps, API Management and Service Bus, with the real CVS shop volunteer scenario and Rimal et al. (2009) citation
BPaaS	BPaaS Business Process as a Service with market evidence ($63.3B, MarketsandMarkets 2024), all three year roadmap entries including the £65M legacy donation workflow, Shopify Plus e-commerce fulfilment and volunteer management automation

Sustainability Discussion

Energy Efficiency

- CVS on-premises PUE: 1.8-2.0
  (half all energy goes to cooling)
- Azure UK South PUE: 1.12
- 40% more efficient per unit of computation
- Source: Uptime Institute (2023) & Microsoft (2024)

Microsoft Green Commitments

- Carbon negative by 2030
- Remove all historical emissions by 2050
- 100% renewable energy matching via Power Purchase Agreements
- Emissions Impact Dashboard free for all Azure customers
- Scope 1, 2 and 3 reporting

Critical Evaluation

- Renewable claims use market-based RECs - not direct green supply
- Independent analysts: overstates real-world impact (Carbone4, 2023)
- BUT: cloud utilisation 60-80% vs 15-20% on-premises (LBNL, 2016)
- Net result: genuine environmental

Cloud migration is not only financially sound - it is the right environmental decision for a charity accountable to its donors and beneficiaries

CVS Cloud Migration - Microsoft Azure is the right choice because:

- ✓ Replaces £14.9M in failing legacy IT with £1.2M/year cloud spend
- ✓ SaaS eliminates £7M legacy CRM cost - Salesforce NPSP free for charities (Salesforce, 2024)
- ✓ PaaS e-commerce portal creates new income stream from 260 shops
- ✓ IaaS eliminates £6.4M hardware spend via virtualisation (Erl et al., 2013)
- ✓ Azure UK South - UK GDPR compliant for 6.4GB donor data (ICO, 2021)
- ✓ Carbon-negative commitment by 2030 - PUE 1.12 vs 1.9 on-premises (Microsoft, 2024)

Cloud migration is not just a technology upgrade for CVS.
It is the mechanism through which CVS funds the next chapter of its charitable work for vulnerable people.

Key References: Erl, Puttini & Mahmood (2013) | Gartner (2023) | ICO (2021) | Khajeh-Hosseini et al. (2010) | Mazrekaj, Shabani & Sejdiu (2016) | Microsoft (2024) | Salesforce (2024) | Turnbull (2014) | Uptime Institute (2023)